

**Problem 2 (20 points).** Here are some phrases in the Liberian dialect of Looma and their English translations:

|           |              |         |              |             |                         |
|-----------|--------------|---------|--------------|-------------|-------------------------|
| ga yila   | our dog      | nà baka | my lesson    | daala       | tomato                  |
| kilikamai | the cucumber | ta woli | their goat   | ga laala    | our tomato              |
| nà bulu   | my bread     | dɔwɔi   | the market   | tɔwɔ        | green bean              |
| nà koya   | my monkey    | ta βele | their house  | pelei       | the road                |
| ta woya   | their monkey | doso    | the hunter   | ta yilikama | their cucumber          |
| nà pele   | my house     | ta loso | their hunter | ga wulu     | [ our tree<br>our bread |

(a) Translate into English in all possible ways:

1. ta lɔwɔ
2. ga βaka
3. boli
4. nà gulu

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Below are some sentences in the Liberian dialect of Looma and their English translations:

|            |                  |                 |                         |
|------------|------------------|-----------------|-------------------------|
| gà gutuzu  | I shorten it.    | gilai ya βalazu | The dog grows.          |
| tɔ kàzu    | It sees me.      | ta βele βαβε    | Their road is good.     |
| ta tùlizu  | They call me.    | nà pupu ya lezu | My ant climbs.          |
| te βalaβε  | They are big.    | gà bolii lulizu | I call the goat.        |
| tɔ te lezu | It lifts them.   | gà nà kɔvi lazu | I lay down my firewood. |
| ge wutuβε  | We are short.    | ta lazu         | They lie down.          |
| biiβε      | It is heavy.     | tavei ya paazu  | The pipe kills it.      |
| tɔ dazu    | It lays it down. | koyai ya gutuzu | The monkey shortens it. |

(b) Translate into English:

5. paβε
6. gà balazu
7. ga ga lave yazu
8. ta ta yila βaazu

(c) Translate into Looma:

9. I am big.
10. They lay me down.
11. We are heavy.
12. Our ant lies down.
13. I kill them.
14. It lifts their firewood.

△ Looma belongs to the Mande family. It is spoken by approx. 560,000 people in Liberia and Guinea.

w = w in English *week*. β and γ are similar to b and g, respectively, but pronounced with a continuous airflow. ɔ and ε are pronounced like o and e, respectively, but with wider open mouth. Doubled vowels are pronounced long.

Looma has two tones: the mark ^ above the vowel denotes the low tone, while the high tone is unmarked. Some tone markers have been omitted from this problem for simplicity.

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